

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9
 ♥ 10 5 3 2
 ♦ Q J 9 6 4 2
 ♣ 10 7

♠ A K Q 7 5 2

♥ 8 6 4

♦ 7 5

♣ 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 8 6
 ♥ 9 7
 ♦ 10 8 3
 ♣ J 9 8 4

♠ 4 3

♥ A K Q J

♦ A K

♣ A K Q 5 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

7NT by South

Lead: ♦ Q

North's 3NT rebid shows 6 ♠s headed by A K Q and nothing else. South is to play 7NT. West leads the ♦ Q.

Nice hand. You have 12 high card tricks and either a 3-2 ♠ split or a 3-3 ♣ split will land this Grand Slam. But even if neither suit splits nicely you can STILL make it if the same defender holds 4 cards in both suits; in that case you will squeeze for the thirteenth trick.

You win the ♦ K.

Win the ♦ K and (**IMPORTANT!**) test the ♣s first by playing ♣ A K Q. Darn. West discards a ♦ on the ♣ Q.

Alright, so East holds the ♣ Guard. You still need to exercise caution.

Play your 4 ♥ winner's next. West follows suit while East follows twice, then discards 2 ♦ s.

Don't play ♠s yet!

Play your ♦ A. East must give up.

If he throws the ♣ J, you win. But if he throws a ♠ you also win. This is what is called a Win-Win bridge play.

Board 2

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 3
♥ Q 10 7 2
♦ J 10 8 4
♣ 6 3

♠ 10 6

♥ A K 8 6

♦ 9 7 3

♣ A K Q J

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 7 4 2

♥ J 4

♦ A 6 5 2

♣ 9 5 2

♠ A K Q J

♥ 9 5 3

♦ K Q

♣ 10 8 7 4

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by South			
Lead: ♦ J			

South is to play 6NT. West leads the ♦ J. East takes the ♦ A and returns the ♦ 2.

Your 4 ♠ tricks, 2 ♥ tricks, 1 ♦ trick and 4 ♣ tricks are very easy to find. But that's only 11, so where in the world can you possibly find number 12?

With all those high ♦ s falling on the first two tricks dummy's ♦ 9 has become a threat against West. If it should happen that West also holds the only ♥ stopper you can squeeze him in the red suits.

You are going to run your black suit winners, taking the ♣ s first so you can be playing winners from your hand when you squeeze West.

On the last 2 ♣ s West discards a ♦ and a ♥.

Now come to your hand with the ♠ A and play the ♠ K Q.

You discard a small ♥ from dummy while West follows suit three times.

It is time.

West discards the ♥ 7, holding on to the ♦ 10.

Play your ♠ J and watch what West discards.

If he holds on to the ♦ 10 you will discard dummy's useless ♦ 9 and hope the ♥ s all fall under the ♥ A K.

If he discards the ♦ 10 then you throw dummy's small ♥ and dummy wins the last three tricks.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 4 2
 ♥ J 10 9 6 3
 ♦ 8 6 4
 ♣ J 6

♠ A K Q 5

♥ 7 5

♦ 10 7 2

♣ A 10 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 8 6

♥ A 8 4 2

♦ 5

♣ K 9 4 2

♠ 9 3

♥ K Q

♦ A K Q J 9 3

♣ Q 8 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♥	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by South

Lead: ♥J

trick 3.

Then start running the ♦ suit.

This is the situation after you have unblocked dummy's ♣A and then played 5 ♦ winners.

So far neither defender is hurting, but that is about to change.

West discards.

You play your ♦3 and discard dummy's ♣10.

East is squeezed. He can't throw his ♣K without letting your ♣Q become a winner. But if he discards a ♠ dummy's ♠5 will win the last trick. This is soooo much fun.

South is to play 6NT. West leads the ♥J. East wins the ♥A and returns the ♥2.

With only 11 winners you need to find one more and your prospects are quite slim.

No matter how the ♠s split only one defender will hold the Guard because only one defender can have as many as 4. IF (it's a big IF) that same defender holds the ♣K then you can squeeze him.

Can you see how the squeeze is going to work?

If you try to run your ♦s right away you will have a problem with your ♣Q later on. It will be no good as a Threat card because you will have no entry back to your hand.

West plays low.

The solution is the Vienna Coup: a ♣ to the ♣A at

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 6 4

♥ 10

♦ 10 9 7 4 2

♣ 8 2

♠ 9 3

♥ K 9 8 6 3

♦ A 6

♣ A K Q 5



♠ A 8 5 2

♥ 4

♦ K Q 8 3

♣ J 10 9 3

♠ K 7

♥ A Q J 7 5 2

♦ J 5

♣ 7 6 4

West	North	East	South
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Pass	3♣	Pass	1♥
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Pass	6♥		3♥
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All Pass

6♥ by South

Lead: ♠Q

Play 5♥ winners and the ♠K.

Drum roll please.

West discards.

Play your ♥2 and dump dummy's ♦6.

East has no answer.

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♠Q. East wins the ♠A and plays the ♦K.

Of course you have noticed that in most of these hands you are exactly one trick short. No coincidence - it's when you are one trick short and can't find another likely plan that you start to look for a squeeze.

In this hand dummy's fourth ♣ is an obvious Threat, so you should ask yourself if you can find another Threat for when ♣s don't split 3-3. Another thing you have probably noticed is that although 3-3 splits happen about 40% of the time in real life, they **NEVER** happen in these pages!

East's ♦K play helps you find the other Threat. It appears that he must hold the ♦Q also, so your ♦J is now a Threat against East. If he holds 4 ♣s you can squeeze him.